

ZamWay

Making Local Public Transportation Easier to Understand

SOFTWARE PRODUCT PITCH

The Problem: Commuters often know where they want to go, but not which jeepney or bus to take, where to wait, where to get off, how much the trip will cost, or whether the route is still operating.

The Idea: ZamWay is a mobile app that turns local jeepney and bus routes into simple, step-by-step commuting instructions.

Primary SDG: SDG 11 – Sustainable Cities and Communities

1. The Problem We Want to Solve

Local public transportation can be difficult to navigate, especially for students, first-time commuters, visitors, and anyone traveling to an unfamiliar area. Unlike private ride-hailing services, jeepney and bus systems require passengers to understand routes, terminals, boarding points, transfers, and drop-off locations.

A commuter may have questions such as:

- Which jeepney or bus should I take?
- Where should I wait for it?
- Where should I get off?
- Do I need to transfer to another vehicle?
- How much money should I prepare?
- Is this route still operating at this time?
- When is the last trip?

The information exists, but it is often scattered, informal, or dependent on local knowledge. ZamWay aims to organize this information into one easy-to-use system.

2. Our Solution

ZamWay is a mobile public transportation navigation system focused specifically on local jeepney and bus travel. Users enter where they are and where they want to go. ZamWay then calculates practical public transportation options and explains the trip step by step.

ZamWay answers the entire commuting question:

What do I ride? Where do I wait? Where do I get off? How much? How long? Is it still operating?

3. How ZamWay Works

- 1. Enter destination** — The passenger provides their starting point and destination.
- 2. Calculate routes** — ZamWay checks available jeepney and bus routes and possible transfers.
- 3. Compare options** — The app can present the cheapest, fastest, or simplest route.
- 4. Follow instructions** — The user receives clear boarding, transfer, and drop-off instructions.
- 5. Track trip status** — The app shows route operating information and estimated first/last trips.
- 6. Ride with confidence** — An optional 'I'm Riding Now' feature shows upcoming stops and can remind the user when to get off.

4. Example User Journey

From: KCC Mall **To:** Western Mindanao State University (WMSU)

Step	ZamWay Recommendation	Estimated Cost
1	Walk to the recommended jeepney terminal	₱0
2	Ride Jeepney Route A toward City Proper	₱13
3	Get off at the recommended transfer point	—
4	Ride Jeepney Route B toward WMSU	₱13
Total	2 rides	₱26

Result: Instead of asking multiple people or guessing which vehicle to take, the commuter gets one clear plan for the entire trip.

5. Core Features

Route Planner — Calculates jeepney and bus combinations from origin to destination.

Boarding Point — Shows where the user should wait for the recommended vehicle.

Drop-off Guidance — Identifies where the user should get off.

Fare Calculator — Estimates the total fare for the complete journey, including transfers.

Travel Time — Provides an estimated trip duration.

Route Operating Status — Shows whether a route is currently operating.

First and Last Trip — Displays scheduled or estimated operating hours.

Route Comparison — Lets users compare cheapest, fastest, and fewest-transfer options.

I'm Riding Now — Shows upcoming stops and can provide a reminder before the destination.

6. What Makes ZamWay Different?

ZamWay is not trying to compete with general navigation apps by simply showing roads on a map. Its focus is the local public transportation experience. The application is designed around the questions that passengers actually ask when using jeepneys and buses.

Its local twist is the combination of **route information + terminal-to-terminal travel + boarding points + drop-off points + fare estimation + operating hours** in one commuter-focused workflow.

The first version can work using a maintained local transportation database, without requiring every jeepney or bus to have a GPS tracker. Real-time tracking can be added later.

7. Who Benefits?

- **Students:** Easier commuting to and from school.

- **First-time commuters:** Less dependence on asking strangers for directions.
- **Visitors:** Easier understanding of unfamiliar local routes.
- **Daily commuters:** Faster comparison of routes, fares, and schedules.
- **Transport stakeholders:** A structured way to publish and maintain route information.

8. Why This Matters

Transportation information is part of transportation accessibility. A route can exist, but if passengers do not understand how to use it, the system is harder to access. ZamWay helps turn existing public transportation into information that people can actually use.

By reducing uncertainty, ZamWay can help commuters make better decisions about cost, travel time, transfers, and route availability.

9. SDG Connection

SDG 11 – Sustainable Cities and Communities

ZamWay supports sustainable and inclusive communities by improving access to local public transportation information. Making jeepney and bus routes easier to understand can encourage the use of existing public transportation and help commuters navigate cities more confidently.

Additional SDG connections:

- **SDG 9 – Industry, Innovation and Infrastructure:** Uses software to improve access to transportation infrastructure information.
- **SDG 10 – Reduced Inequalities:** Helps reduce the information barrier faced by people unfamiliar with local transportation systems.
- **SDG 13 – Climate Action:** Better public transportation information may encourage greater use of shared transportation and reduce unnecessary private vehicle trips.

10. Future Potential

- Real-time jeepney and bus location tracking
- Crowdsourced reports for delays, route changes, or unavailable vehicles
- Traffic-aware travel-time estimates
- Authorized operator or administrator route updates
- Offline access to basic route information
- Accessibility features
- Service-disruption and emergency notifications

11. The Vision

Our vision is simple: make commuting less confusing.

ZamWay aims to become a practical local commuting companion that tells passengers not only where they are going, but exactly how to get there using the public transportation already available in their community.

ZamWay — Know your route. Know your ride. Get there with confidence.